

The Great Conduit

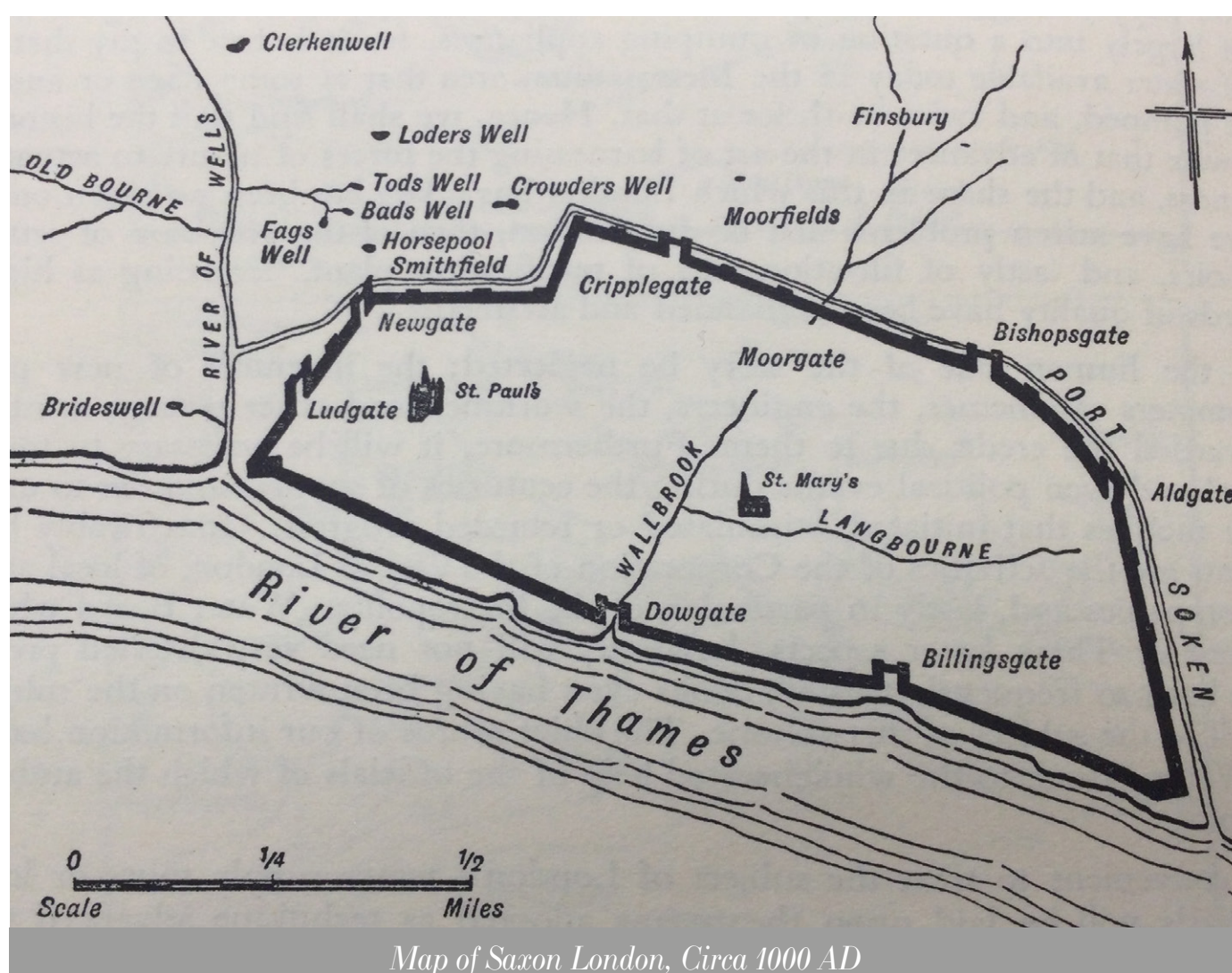
No. 165

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

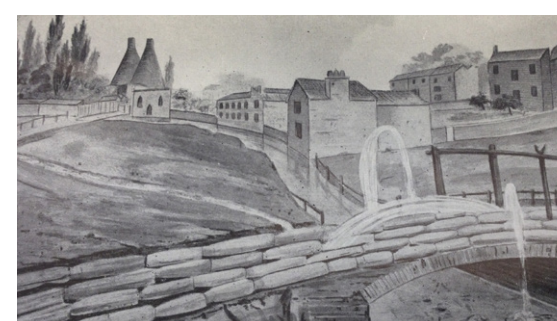
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Until the early medieval period, Londoners relied on the River Fleet, the River Walbrook, or local wells for water, but these could not meet the needs of a growing city. In 1237, a conduit from the River Tyburn (near modern Bond Street) was built, bringing water through Charing Cross, the Strand, Fleet Street, and Cheapside.

The Fleet Street Conduit was a stone tower decorated with St. Christopher, angels, and bells. It supplied water, featured in pageants, and even flowed with wine for royal ceremonies, including Anne Boleyn's coronation. The Conduit was also used for posting proclamations, though overflowing pipes frequently damaged nearby homes and businesses, prompting repeated petitions to the Lord Mayor for repairs.



Map of Saxon London, Circa 1000 AD



The conduit passing over the River Fleet



The Conduit of River Fleet